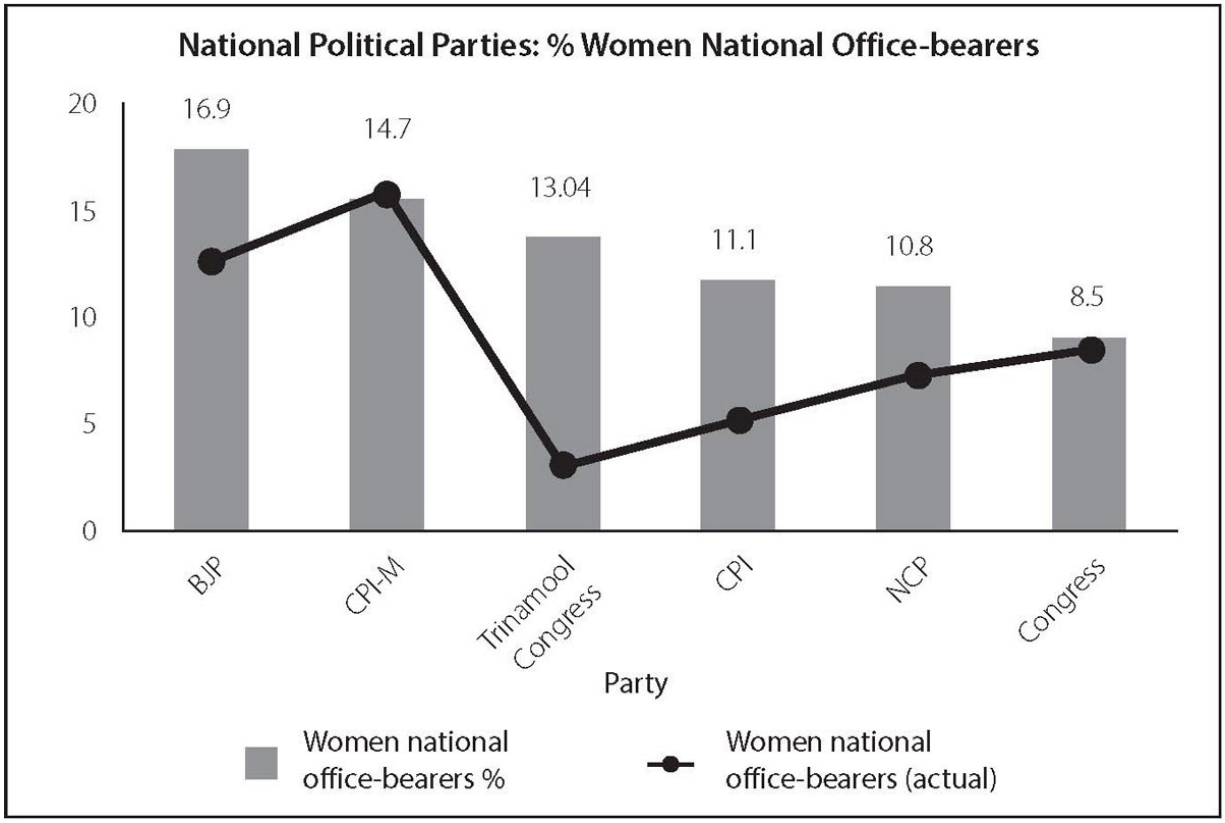
was credited with the RJD's revival in the tribal state after 2014. She defected to the BJP in March 2019 and was rewarded with a senior position.[81] D.K. Aruna from Telengana, a Reddy leader from an old Congress family who had previously held ministerial positions in Congress governments in undivided Andhra Pradesh, was also a defector. She joined the BJP in 2018. Her elevation, and that of another former Congress leader, D. Purandeswari (from Andhra Pradesh), to the important post of general secretary represented the party's southern ambitions.[82]

Table 17.10: The BJP Has the Highest Ratio of Women as National Office-bearers Among National Political Parties, the Congress Has the Lowest



Source: The author's analysis of central leadership of six national parties recognised by the ECI. In October 2020, the BJP had twelve women out of seventy-one national office-bearers, CPI(M) had fifteen women out of 102, the CPI had seven of sixty-three, the NCP five of forty-six and the Congress eight out of ninety-four. Note: For a meaningful comparison, we chose national parties with a minimum threshold of at least ten central officer bearers. The BSP, also a national party, had only four national officer bearers, including its president Mayawati (25 per cent representation) but its proportional representation of women is not comparable with others because of the small size of its